



PROJECT CHARTER

Project Title: Surplus Food Redistribution Network

Team Name: Catalyst Alliance

UN Sustainable Development Goal: Goal 2 – Zero Hunger

Date: July 2026

Document Status: Final

Project Summary

Catalyst Alliance is developing a practical, web-based prototype for a Surplus Food Redistribution Network that addresses food waste and hunger by connecting grocery vendors with surplus perishable food to food pantries, NGOs, and communities in need.

The project is aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 2 (Zero Hunger) and focuses on improving food redistribution through a coordinated, hyper-local system. The initial project scope focuses on Nigeria, South Africa, and Kenya, reflecting the countries represented by the project team. The proposed solution is designed with the potential to be adapted for other African countries facing similar food waste and food insecurity challenges.

The solution is primarily grounded in African research, reports, and statistics. Where publicly accessible African operational retail food waste datasets are limited, relevant African reports, statistics, and available country-level data are used to inform the prototype, while selected findings from a cleaned publicly available operational dataset are used only as supporting evidence to demonstrate how inventory analytics can identify surplus and prioritise redistribution opportunities.

Project Goals

By 14 August 2026, Catalyst Alliance will design and present a research-backed prototype of a Surplus Food Redistribution Network that demonstrates how surplus food can be efficiently redistributed from grocery vendors to organizations and communities in need. The project will include supporting research, implementation planning, technical documentation, and all required submission materials.

Deliverables

- Project Charter
- Research and supporting datasets
- Stakeholder analysis
- Solution proposal
- Website prototype (MVP)
- GitHub repository and documentation
- README.md
- Implementation plan
- Final presentation materials
- Five-minute walkthrough video
- Final project summary

Business Case / Background

Food waste and food insecurity continue to exist simultaneously across many African communities. While grocery vendors often dispose of surplus perishable food due to storage limitations or the absence of efficient redistribution systems, many households and community organizations struggle to access sufficient food.

The current lack of an automated, hyper-local coordination platform creates barriers between food donors and recipients, resulting in avoidable waste and missed opportunities to address hunger

Due to the limited availability of publicly accessible operational retail food waste datasets for African countries, the project primarily uses African reports, statistics, and supporting literature to establish the problem context and inform the proposed solution. A cleaned publicly available operational dataset is retained as supporting evidence to demonstrate how inventory analytics can identify surplus and prioritise redistribution opportunities, while its non-African origin is clearly acknowledged.

This project seeks to explore a practical, scalable solution to improve food redistribution through technology while supporting the objectives of UN Sustainable Development Goal 2: Zero Hunger.

Expected Benefits

- Reduce food waste through improved coordination.

- Improve access to surplus food for organizations and communities in need.
- Demonstrate a practical technology-driven solution.
- Encourage collaboration among vendors, NGOs, and local communities.
- Produce a portfolio-ready multidisciplinary project.

Scope and Exclusion

In Scope

- Research on food waste and redistribution.
- Stakeholder analysis.
- Analysis of food waste and redistribution challenges, with primary focus on Nigeria, South Africa, and Kenya, while drawing supporting evidence from other African countries where relevant.
- Design of a web-based prototype (MVP).
- Documentation and project management artifacts.
- GitHub repository.
- Final presentation and walkthrough video.

Out of Scope

- Mobile application development.
- Full production deployment.
- Real-time logistics operations.
- Integration with payment systems.
- Nationwide implementation beyond the selected project focus.

Project Team

Team Member	Project Role	Key Responsibilities
Oluwatoyin Oke	Project Manager	Project planning, meeting facilitation, timeline management, documentation, stakeholder coordination, risk management, and overall project oversight.

Omoruyi Igbinovia	Data Analyst	Conduct research, gather and analyze datasets, validate the problem, and provide data-driven insights to support solution development.
Lydia Nganga	Automation & Web Development Lead	Lead website prototype development, GitHub repository management, automation support, and technical implementation.
Zoliswa Mokopu	Cybersecurity Specialist	Identify security considerations, assess potential risks, and recommend secure practices for the proposed solution.
Esther Vincent	Digital Marketing & Communications Lead	Contribute to user awareness, communication strategy, presentation materials, and support documentation from a user engagement perspective.

Key Stakeholders

Primary Stakeholders

- Grocery vendors
- Food pantries
- NGOs and food banks

- Community members experiencing food insecurity

Secondary Stakeholders

- Volunteers
- Local communities
- Government agencies
- Community-based organizations

Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if it:

- Delivers all required submission materials before the deadline.
- Demonstrates a practical and realistic solution to the assigned problem.
- Uses credible research and supporting data.
- Produces a functional website prototype.
- Maintains an organized and well-documented GitHub repository.
- Clearly communicates the proposed solution through documentation and the final walkthrough.

Assumptions

- African reports, statistics, and supporting literature will provide sufficient evidence to establish the problem context and inform the proposed solution. Where African operational datasets are unavailable, selected findings from a cleaned publicly available operational dataset will be used only to demonstrate relevant analytical concepts and will not be presented as representative of African retail conditions.
- Team members will actively contribute according to their areas of expertise.
- The selected technology stack will be sufficient to demonstrate the MVP within the project timeline.
- The team will maintain regular communication throughout the project.

Project Constraints

- Project duration is limited to one month.
- Deliverables must be completed before 14 August 2026.
- Limited availability of publicly accessible operational retail food waste

datasets for African countries.

- The prototype demonstrates the concept and is not intended for production deployment.

Initial Risks & Mitigation Plan

Risk	Mitigation
Limited time available before the submission deadline	Maintain regular meetings and monitor progress weekly.
Limited availability of African operational retail datasets	Use African reports, statistics, and data to ground the problem and inform the MVP. Use selected findings from the cleaned non-African operational dataset only as supporting analytical evidence, with its limitations clearly documented.
Delays in research or data collection	Begin research early and share resources continuously.
Technical challenges during prototype development	Collaborate closely and address blockers as soon as they arise.
Limited GitHub experience among team members	Share knowledge and provide support during repository setup and collaboration.
Scheduling conflicts across team members	Continue using shared communication channels and agree on meeting times in advance.

Approval

This Project Charter has been reviewed by Catalyst Alliance and serves as the guiding document for the planning and execution of the Surplus Food Redistribution Network project. Any significant changes to the project scope, objectives, or deliverables will be reviewed and agreed upon by the project team.